- *The actor provider*—It can be a `local` or a `cluster`. The `local` option is used for applications that do not require distribution, such as a streaming processor or an HTTP server. Otherwise, you can choose the `cluster` provider to allow actors to be created in any node. To do this, set `akka.actor.provider = cluster` in the configuration.
- *The remote*—This is the internal mechanism through which actors on different nodes communicate with each other.
- *The seed nodes*—The list of hosts, ports, and `ActorSystem` names of the start nodes. Remember, seed nodes are not the only option, but let's focus on them for now.

Listing 8.1 Configuring the seed nodes in application.conf

```
akka {
  actor {
    provider = "cluster"                    ❶
  }
  remote {                                  ❷
    artery {
      transport = tcp
      canonical.hostname = 127.0.0.1
      canonical.port = ${PORT}
    }
  }
  cluster {                                 ❸
    seed-nodes = [
     "akka://words@127.0.0.1:2551",
     "akka://words@127.0.0.1:2552",
     "akka://words@127.0.0.1:2553"
    ]                                       ❹

  }
}
```

❶ Initializes the cluster module

❷ Remote configuration for this seed node

❸ Cluster configuration section